

This guide explains what cryptodash does, what you will see on the dashboard, what the system does automatically, and what you need to do as a user. No technical knowledge required.

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1. What is cryptodash?

cryptodash is a personal crypto trading assistant running on your Raspberry Pi. It watches a list of coins 24 hours a day, analyses market conditions using technical indicators, reads recent news, and uses Claude AI to generate plain English buy/sell/hold signals. When all conditions are right it automatically places paper trades (simulated — no real money) via Freqtrade.

■ What cryptodash does automatically (no input needed):

- Watches your coin watchlist 24/7
- Calculates 9 technical indicators every 10 minutes from local data
- Reads crypto news headlines every 30 minutes
- Checks the market Fear & Greed level every hour
- Generates an AI signal for each coin every 10 minutes
- Places paper trades automatically when all 13 checks pass
- Monitors open trades — stop loss, take profit, 72h time stop
- Scans the top 100 coins every hour for new opportunities outside your watchlist
- Sends desktop notifications when trades open or close

✓ What YOU need to do:

- Check the dashboard whenever you want — no schedule required
- Review learning analysis recommendations every few weeks (5 minutes)
- Decide whether to add scanner-found coins to your watchlist
- Switch to live trading when you are confident — your decision, never automatic

2. The Two Screens

Two web interfaces run on your Pi — access both from any browser on your local network.

Screen	Address	What it shows	How often to check
cryptodash	http://localhost:3000	Signals, indicators, scanner, backtest	Whenever you want — signals update every 10 min
FreqUI (Freqtrade)	http://localhost:8080	Open trades, trade history, P&L;, bot status	When you get a notification or for a daily review

3. Understanding the Signals

Every coin gets a signal updated every 10 minutes, generated by Claude AI after analysing all 9 technical indicators, recent news and market sentiment.

STRONG BUY	BUY	HOLD	SELL	STRONG SELL
Signal	What it means		What the bot does	
STRONG BUY	All 9 entry criteria met with high conviction. Indicators aligned, stop loss safe, 10% target achievable within 72h.		Places a paper trade automatically if Freqtrade dataframe also confirms.	
BUY	Most criteria met but one is marginal. Reasonable setup but not high enough conviction for automatic entry.		No automatic trade. You can place a manual paper trade if you choose.	
HOLD	Mixed signals. Setup incomplete or timing poor. Not enough conviction to enter or exit.		Nothing — wait for a clearer signal.	
SELL	Indicators lean bearish. If you have an open position, consider tightening your stop loss.		If closeOnSignalReversal is on: closes open position on next hour candle.	
STRONG SELL	Multiple bearish signals aligned. High probability of further downside.		Closes any open position on the next hour candle automatically.	

4. The 9 Entry Criteria for a Trade

A STRONG BUY is only generated when ALL 9 criteria pass simultaneously. If even one fails the signal drops to BUY, HOLD or lower. This is intentionally strict — better to miss a trade than enter a bad one.

#	Criteria	Plain English
1	Price above 200 EMA	Coin is in a confirmed long-term uptrend. Never trade against the long-term trend.
2	RSI 25–45	Coin has pulled back and is oversold but not broken. Buying a dip, not chasing a rally.
3	Price within 5% of 50 EMA	Price is at its natural mean reversion point where it tends to bounce.

4	MACD above zero	Momentum is still net positive despite the pullback. The trend has not fully broken.
5	StochRSI below 30, turning up	A more sensitive indicator confirming selling pressure is exhausted.
6	Volume above 1.2× average	Real buyers are present. A move on low volume is likely to fail.
7	Funding rate not above +0.05%	Futures traders are not dangerously overleveraged long. Avoids entering a long squeeze.
8	Fear & Greed below 60	Market is not euphoric. Only buy into fear or neutrality — never into greed.
9	No high-weight negative news in last 4h	No known negative catalyst. Avoids buying into a breaking bad news story.

■ Why no trades are firing right now:

- Bitcoin is ~41% below its 200 EMA — the market is in a confirmed downtrend
- MACD is deeply negative and StochRSI is elevated across all watchlist coins
- The bot is correctly protecting capital by refusing to trade in bad conditions
- Trades will fire automatically once BTC recovers and all 9 criteria align
- Use this time to watch the scanner and review backtest results

5. What Happens When a Trade Fires

When all 9 Claude criteria AND all 4 Freqtrade confirmation checks pass simultaneously a trade is placed with no human input needed.

1	Signal generated Every 10 min Claude evaluates all 9 criteria. All 9 pass → signal = STRONG BUY.
2	Freqtrade confirms at the top of the hour Freqtrade independently checks EMA200, RSI, MACD and volume on its own data.
3	Trade placed automatically All 13 checks pass. Freqtrade places a dry-run BUY at current market price. Position size = 1% portfolio risk ÷ 5% stop = ~£200.
4	Notification sent to your Pi "Auto trade: BUY BTC/GBP @ £69,240 SL: £65,778 TP: £76,164"
5	Trade monitored every 60 seconds Freqtrade checks price against stop loss and take profit every minute.
6	Trade closes — one of four ways Take profit (+10%), stop loss (-5%), time stop (72h), or signal reversal.
7	Closing notification sent "TAKE PROFIT: BTC/GBP @ £76,164 +£18.29" or "STOP LOSS: BTC/GBP @ £65,778 -£11.69"
8	Trade recorded for learning Full record saved including all 9 indicator values at entry. Learning analysis updates after every 5 closed trades.

6. Trade Mechanics — The Numbers

A concrete example with a £1,000 paper portfolio and BTC entry at £69,240:

Item	Calculation	Result
Portfolio value	—	£1,000.00
Risk per trade	£1,000 × 1%	£10.00
Stop loss distance	Fixed at 5%	5%
Position size	£10 risk ÷ 5% stop	£200.00
Units purchased	£200 ÷ £69,240	0.00289 BTC
Entry fee (0.40%)	£200 × 0.40%	£0.80
Stop loss price	£69,240 × 95%	£65,778

Take profit price	$£69,240 \times 110\%$	£76,164
Time stop	72 hours after entry	Automatic

Outcome	What happens	Net P&L;
Take profit at £76,164	Freqtrade sells at £76,164. Exit fee 0.25% (maker) = £0.50.	+£18.29 (+9.1%)
Stop loss at £65,778	Freqtrade sells at ~£65,664 after slippage. Exit fee 0.40% = £0.76.	-£11.56 (-5.8%)
72h time stop	Closes at market price after 72 hours regardless of P&L.;	Depends on price
Signal reversal	STRONG SELL fires. Freqtrade closes on next hourly candle.	Depends on price

7. Dashboard Tabs — What Each One Does

Watchlist — your main view

- Live prices, 24h change and signal badge for each coin
- Signal subrow shows the AI summary in plain English beneath each coin
- Gauge row shows all indicators at a glance — RSI bar, MACD arrow, BB position, EMA dots, F&G;
- Click "▼ explain indicators" to expand a full breakdown with plain English explanations and tooltips
- Strategy Alignment section shows which of the 9 criteria are passing or failing right now
- Click any sparkline to open a full candlestick chart with volume and RSI panels
- Use "+ Add coin" to add a coin (enter its CoinGecko ID e.g. "polkadot")
- Click a coin tag to remove it from your watchlist

Opportunities — the market scanner

- Scans the top 100 Binance coins every hour for setups outside your watchlist
- Shows a single best candidate — either Tier 0 (NEW RISER) or Tier C (DIP IN UPTREND)
- Tier 0: coin just broke above its 200 EMA with volume confirmation — early entry opportunity
- Tier C: coin in a confirmed uptrend pulling back to its 50 EMA — safer entry
- Blank = no qualifying candidates found — the filters are working correctly
- "Scan Now" triggers an immediate fresh scan
- "Add to Watchlist" adds the candidate — Freqtrade will monitor it from the next hour

Backtest — historical signal analysis

- Select a coin and days, click "Run Backtest" — takes 30-60 seconds
- Market phase banner shows whether the test period was bull, bear or mixed
- £100 simulation shows what £100 would have become following the signals with 0.40% fees
- Phase-split panel shows win rate in bull conditions vs bear conditions separately
- Equity curve compares the strategy against buy-and-hold for the same period
- Use this to understand signal quality before committing to live trading

Portfolio — paper trading monitor

- Shows your paper trading balance, open positions and P&L;
- Place manual paper trades from the order panel
- Configure auto execution settings (off by default)
- View trade history with entry/exit details and close reasons
- Learning analysis panel shows recommendations after every 5 closed trades
- For now also use FreqUI at <http://localhost:8080> for detailed trade monitoring

8. Notifications

Your Pi sends desktop notifications for key events. You do not need the dashboard open.

Notification	Meaning	Action needed?
"Auto trade: BUY BTC/GBP @ £XX"	Freqtrade placed a paper trade. All 13 checks passed.	No — check FreqUI if curious
"TAKE PROFIT: +£XX"	Trade hit the 10% target and closed profitably.	No — review in FreqUI
"STOP LOSS: -£XX"	Trade dropped 5% and closed at the stop loss. Normal risk management.	No
"TIME STOP after 72h"	Trade did not hit either target in 72 hours.	No — check what conditions looked like
"Signal reversal exit"	Signal flipped to SELL while a trade was open. Closed early.	No — check new signal in dashboard
"Daily loss limit reached"	Auto trading suspended for today. Resets at midnight.	No — resumes automatically
"Learning Analysis ready"	Enough trades have closed to generate strategy insights.	Yes — review recommendations in Portfolio tab
"Scanner: opportunity found"	A coin outside your watchlist meets entry criteria.	Optional — check Opportunities tab

9. Learning Analysis

After every 5 closed trades the system analyses which conditions led to winning vs losing trades and generates recommendations to improve the strategy. This is the only part that requires your input.

Trades closed	Level	What you see
5	Early Signals	Basic stats only — win rate, average gain/loss. No recommendations yet — too few trades.
10	First Analysis	Up to 2 recommendations with LOW confidence. For example: "RSI below 35 wins 64% of trades vs only 28% for RSI 35-45."
20	Full Analysis	Up to 4 recommendations with MEDIUM confidence. All correlations run — RSI, market phase, Fear & Greed, exit timing, coin performance.
30+	High Confidence	Full recommendation set with HIGH confidence where enough trade data supports it.

What to do when a recommendation arrives:

1	Get a notification "Learning Analysis ready — 2 recommendations in Portfolio tab"
2	Open the Portfolio tab on the dashboard Go to http://localhost:3000 and click Portfolio
3	Read the recommendation Example: "Tighten RSI filter from 25-45 to 25-35. Win rate at RSI 25-35: 64% (18 trades) vs RSI 35-45: 28% (7 trades). Fewer signals, higher quality."
4	Click Accept or Reject Accept updates the strategy parameter immediately. Reject keeps the current setting. Both are logged with timestamp.

10. Going Live — When and How

Switching from paper trading to real money is always a deliberate manual step. The system will never move real money without you explicitly enabling it.

Complete all of these before going live:

	Requirement	Why
■	Paper trading running 60+ days	Enough trade history for meaningful statistics
■	Win rate above 40%	Minimum threshold for a viable strategy
■	Risk/reward ratio above 1.5:1	Wins must outweigh losses net of fees
■	No daily loss limit hits in last 2 weeks	Strategy is stable and not over-trading
■	At least one learning analysis completed	System has self-reviewed and you have actioned recommendations
■	Kraken account funded with GBP	Real account ready to trade
■	Kraken API keys with trading permissions generated	Keys ready but not yet in the system

How to switch to live trading:

1	Add Kraken API keys Edit /home/gallus23/freqtrade/user_data/config.json — set exchange.key and exchange.secret
2	Change dry_run to false In the same file: "dry_run": false
3	Restart Freqtrade sudo systemctl restart freqtrade
4	Verify in FreqUI Open http://localhost:8080 — the "Dry run" badge should be gone. Check wallet shows your real Kraken GBP balance.
5	Monitor closely for first week Check FreqUI daily. Start at 50% of intended position sizes. You can revert to dry_run: true at any time.

■ Live trading safety reminders:

- Never enable the Withdraw permission on your Kraken API key — only trading permissions
- Start with 50% position sizes for the first two weeks
- The daily loss limit (£50) suspends auto trading if hit — check your notifications
- You can switch back to dry_run: true at any time to pause live trading
- Never invest more than you can afford to lose entirely

11. Suggested Routine

You do not need to monitor constantly. Here is all that is needed:

When	What to do	Time
Morning (optional)	Glance at watchlist — check signal classifications and any overnight changes	2 min
Trade notification received	Check FreqUI to see the open position — entry price, stop loss, take profit	2 min
Trade close notification	Check FreqUI trade history — was it take profit, stop loss, or time stop?	2 min
Learning analysis notification	Open Portfolio tab, read each recommendation, click Accept or Reject	5-10 min
Weekly	Review FreqUI dashboard — overall P&L, win rate, any patterns in losses	10 min
Monthly	Run a fresh backtest — check if signal quality is improving over time	5 min

Scanner notification	Check Opportunities tab — decide whether to add the coin to your watchlist	5 min
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12. Common Questions

Why are there no trades?

The market is in a downtrend. Bitcoin is below its 200 EMA — the primary entry gate. The strategy correctly refuses to trade downtrends. Trades will fire automatically when BTC recovers and all 9 criteria align. This is working as designed.

Why is every signal **STRONG SELL**?

Multiple bearish indicators are aligned across all coins — price below EMAs, negative MACD, extreme fear. The AI is accurately reading real market weakness. No action needed — just wait.

The Opportunities tab is blank — is something broken?

No. Blank means no coins in the top 100 currently meet the scanner criteria. In a bearish market this is correct. Use "Scan Now" for a fresh check.

My signal timestamp looks old — is it still updating?

Signals update every 10 minutes. If the timestamp is more than 15 minutes old, check the service: `sudo systemctl status crypto-dashboard`

FreqUI shows "Bot is stopped"

Check: `sudo systemctl status freqtrade`. If stopped: `sudo systemctl start freqtrade`

Will both services restart after a Pi reboot?

Yes — both are systemd services set to start on boot. cryptodash starts first, Freqtrade starts after it automatically.

How do I add a new coin?

Click "+ Add coin" in the Watchlist tab (enter the CoinGecko ID e.g. "polkadot"). Also add the GBP pair to Freqtrade config.json pair_whitelist (e.g. "DOT/GBP") and run: `sudo systemctl restart freqtrade`

How do I test the trade pipeline is working?

In FreqUI use the force entry button to place a test trade bypassing signal logic. This lets you verify stop loss, take profit and the 72h time stop all work correctly.

Disclaimer

cryptodash is a personal learning and research tool. All signals and trades are algorithmic and educational — not financial advice. Cryptocurrency trading involves significant risk of loss. Past paper trade performance does not guarantee future real results. Never invest more than you can afford to lose. The developer accepts no liability for any financial losses.